Sadness vs. Depression: Know the Difference

Feeling sad is human. Depression is something different — and it deserves your attention, not your minimization.

Sadness is situational.

It comes with loss, disappointment, pain. It moves. It's healthy, human, and necessary. Grief, for instance, isn't a disorder — it's love with nowhere to go.

Depression is persistent.

It lingers beyond the circumstance. It affects sleep, energy, appetite, focus, and your ability to find joy in things you used to love — for weeks at a time. That's a different animal.

Watch for these signs.

Loss of interest in daily life. Persistent emptiness or hopelessness. Fatigue that doesn't lift with rest. These aren't character flaws. They're clinical signals worth addressing.

You don't have to figure this out alone.

DM 'HELP' to start a conversation about therapy.